OBAMA FOUNDATION LEADERS

Obama Leaders Application

Se termine sur ven. 4 déc. 2026 19:00

PROGRAM SELECTION

The Obama Foundation currently operates the Obama Leaders program in Africa, Asia-Pacific, Europe, and the United States. Please be aware that, even if you meet the eligibility criteria for multiple Leaders programs, you may only submit an application for one program. If you have questions about which program is right for you, please visit our website to learn more about each specific Obama Leaders program and the eligibility requirements that apply.

This application is comprised of 10 sections and will display in two parts. The application will save as you complete it. Feel free to work through the sections at your own pace.

Part 1

1. Basic Information
2. Geographical Information
3. Your Changemaking Work
4. Essay Questions

Part 2

1. Video Questions
2. Short Biography
3. References
4. Resume
5. Additional + Optional Information
6. Data Privacy and TOCs

During the Obamas' tenure in the White House, they traveled across the African continent and witnessed incredible stories of young African leaders carrying the baton for change. Since then, they've formed partnerships to expand opportunities and create new connections for passionate leaders, beginning with the inaugural Leaders Africa program in 2018. Leaders Africa is an eight-month virtual leadership journey for 24-45-year-old leaders from across the continent focused on exploring values-based leadership skills and building deep relationships with fellow cohort members. The Leaders Africa program seeks to identify exceptional leaders in the public, civil society, and private sectors who have a clear issue focus and who can illustrate the impact of their work. Our objective is to build a network of values-driven leaders who create positive, innovative change in their communities, throughout Africa, and around the world.

The Leaders Africa program is currently scheduled to begin the week of September 1, 2027, and will conclude no later than May 1, 2028, with planned breaks throughout. Exact dates are subject to change.

Leaders are required to participate in online programming activities throughout the program term. This will include:

- Practical tools and training for deepening values-based leadership
- Community groups
- Conversations with thought leaders
- Cultural programming that showcases the richness of the region
- Curated spaces for deep personal reflection and interpersonal learning with peers
- Individualized coaching

Please ensure that you are able to commit to the full time required for the program year before applying.

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BASIC INFORMATION

Given Name(s) (requis)

h

Middle Name(s)

Last Name(s)/Surname(s) (requis)

h

Preferred Name

DJAGOUN ABDEL-AZIZ

Email Address (requis)

abdelbilla20@gmail.com

Note: We will be using the email associated with your Submittable account to send important communications about the Obama Leaders program. Please be sure you are checking that email regularly and have our notifications safelisted.

Phone Number (requis)

+229 0167787349

Please enter your birthdate. For ease, please enter the date in the following format: MM/DD/YYYY (requis)

04/12/2000

For example, 25 October 1988 would appear as 10/25/1988.

Please select which of these most closely aligns with your leadership moment as you apply for this program, based on the options below. (requis)

- (●) Starting: I'm taking on leadership for the first time or in a new, unfamiliar context. I'm figuring out my voice, influence, and approach.
- ( ) Building: I'm leading a team or project and learning how to drive results, manage people, and grow trust.
- ( ) Transitioning: I'm reevaluating my leadership: letting go, mentoring others, or reshaping my role to support different areas of change.
- ( ) Sustaining: I'm holding long-term responsibility and focusing on legacy, culture, and system-level influence.
- ( ) Scaling: I have a proven model that I am working to bring to new communities or partners in order to deepen or widen impact.

This question is meant to help us learn more about your background. We welcome applicants in all stages of their leadership journeys.

Do you currently hold an elected position in public office? (requis)

- ( ) Yes
- (●) No

Have you previously applied for any of the following programs? Please select all that apply, regardless of the outcome of your previous applications. (requis)

- [x] Leaders Africa
- [ ] Leaders Asia-Pacific
- [ ] Leaders Europe
- [ ] Leaders USA
- [ ] Obama-Chesky Voyager Scholarship for Public Service
- [ ] Obama Foundation Scholars
- [ ] I have never applied to any of the programs listed above.

Note: Prior applications will not affect your eligibility or consideration.

How did you hear about this program? (requis)

- ( ) Obama Foundation email
- ( ) Obama Foundation staff or information session
- ( ) Obama Foundation program alumni
- (•) Social media
- ( ) Word of mouth (friend, family, colleague, etc.)
- ( ) Other

GEOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

Which of the following best describes you? (requis)

- (•) I am a citizen of a nation or territory in the African region OR I am a permanent resident, refugee, or asylum seeker in an eligible nation or territory OR in the African region
- ( ) I am not a citizen, permanent resident, refugee, or asylum seeker of a nation or territory in the African region but have lived in a nation or territory in the African region for at least the last 5 years.

In which city or town is your primary place of residence located? (requis)

COTONOU

How would you describe the area where you live? (requis)

- (•) Major city
- ( ) Suburb or area near a major city
- ( ) Small city or large town
- ( ) Small town or village
- ( ) Rural community
- ( ) Remote area (far from towns, services, or major transport)

I would identify as an Obama Leader of _____?

Please specify the nation or territory you would represent if selected for the program. This may be the

nation or territory where you currently reside, or it may be a different nation or territory in the region. For instance, your professional activities may have led you to live in one country in the region, but you identify as being of or representing another. (requis)

Benin

YOUR CHANGEMAKING WORK

The questions below reference the work you do that has the most positive social impact. You do not have to be doing your changemaking work full-time nor as your main professional focus to be eligible for the program.

Current job or position title where you do your changemaking work. (requis)

h

Current organization or institution where you do your changemaking work. (requis)

j

What is the mission or purpose of the organization or institution? (requis)

j

Website of the organization or institution where you do your changemaking work. (If not available, please skip this question.)

a.com

Which response best describes your level of engagement with your changemaking work? (requis)

- (●) My changemaking work is my full-time job.
- ( ) I divide my time between my changemaking work and other jobs or professional responsibilities that have a different focus.

Which sector best describes your changemaking work? (requis)

- ( ) Public sector
- ( ) Private sector
- (●) Civil society
- ( ) Not listed
- ( ) Prefer not to say

Which industry best describes your changemaking work? (requis)

Agriculture

Please select the issue area that best reflects the focus of your changemaking work. We understand that there is no perfect way to categorize everyone's work. The categories below reflect the most common categories that we have observed and anticipate in our network. (requis)

Agriculture

If you would like, please use this space to highlight other issue areas that intersect with your work in addition to the primary issue area you already selected.

e

REFERENCES

As part of your application, you are required to provide two references, including their name, email address, and their affiliation with you. Your reference should know you well and be able to speak to your character, leadership qualities, and changemaking work. By providing a reference's information, you represent that you have their permission to provide The Obama Foundation their contact information.

All reference forms must be submitted no later than of December 18 at 12:00 PM United States Central Time (UTC-6), two weeks after the official application deadline, in order for your application to be considered complete. To ensure your references have ample time to complete their forms, we strongly recommend issuing your references before you submit your completed application. Submitting at the last minute may not allow sufficient time for your references to respond.

We cannot provide individual status updates on reference submissions due to the high volume of applications. **Application and Reference request edits will not be permitted, so please review the status in your application and follow up directly with your reference for their submission status.**

⚠️ Please be sure to let your references know to expect the reference request to come from the following email address: notifications@email.submittable.com ⚠️

Feel free to share this related help article with them as well.

Reference 1: Name (requis)

Prénom (requis)

g

Nom de famille (requis)

g

Reference 1: Title (requis)

f

Reference 1: Affiliation (requis)

f

Reference 1: What is your relationship with this reference? (requis)

t

REFERENCE #1 (requis)

Adresse e-mail de référence (requis)

a@gmail.com

Saisissez l'adresse e-mail de la personne que vous souhaitez utiliser comme référence.

Ajouter un message personnel (facultatif)

g

L'envoi d'une demande de référence ne soumettra pas ce formulaire. Vous pouvez envoyer votre demande de référence à tout moment, sinon elle sera envoyée automatiquement lorsque vous soumettez ce formulaire.

Envoyer la demande maintenant

Reference 2: Name (requis)

Prénom (requis)

f

Nom de famille (requis)

f

Reference 2: Title (requis)

g

Reference 2: Affiliation (requis)

g

Reference 2: What is your relationship with this reference? (requis)

d

REFERENCE #2 (requis)

Adresse e-mail de référence (requis)

abdelbilla20@gmail.com

Saisissez l'adresse e-mail de la personne que vous souhaitez utiliser comme référence.

Ajouter un message personnel (facultatif)

h

L'envoi d'une demande de référence ne soumettra pas ce formulaire. Vous pouvez envoyer votre demande de référence à tout moment, sinon elle sera envoyée automatiquement lorsque vous soumettez ce formulaire.

Envoyer la demande maintenant

Essay Questions

The application form will not accept responses outside of the specified word range. We encourage you to write your responses in a separate document first to check the word count and in case you encounter any technical issues while completing your application. While AI may be used as a supplemental resource, please use it strategically to support, rather than drive your application submission. Our goal is to evaluate your unique thinking and background.

In two sentences, describe the specific challenge you are working to address and the approach you are taking to create change. (requis)

d

1 / 50 mots

Example: Too many leaders take on challenges in isolation, without the peer community, resources, and cross-sector relationships that sustain hard work. Through my work, I connect leaders worldwide with experts, coaches, and a values-driven network to deepen their impact at home and spread what works.

What meaningful change has occurred because of your changemaking work, and how do you know? Please include evidence, data, feedback, or other indicators that show that this change occurred. (requis)

f

1 / 250 mots

Why is now the right time for you to participate in this program? Describe a leadership challenge you're currently facing and share a specific example from the past six months of how it has affected your work or your team. How has this experience shaped what you're hoping to gain from the program? (requis)

g

1 / 250 mots

Tell us about a time when achieving the best outcome required you to put the collective ahead of your own role, recognition, or preferred approach. What did you do, what changed, and what did you learn as a result? (requis)

k

1 / 250 mots

As part of our commitment to building a cohort of leaders with varied experiences, approaches, backgrounds, and points of view, we want to understand what makes each applicant unique. What would be missing from our cohort if you were not included? (requis)

k

1 / 250 mots

Are you ready to continue to Part 2? (requis)

- [x] Yes

VIDEO INTRODUCTIONS

Tell us about yourself by creating a video response to each of the 2 prompts below.

- Each response must be saved and uploaded as its own separate video file.
- Do not combine both answers into a single recording or video file.
- Please begin your video by introducing yourself and providing your full name.
- Please speak directly and spontaneously. We want to hear your reflection, not a rehearsed script.
- Your videos should be in English and no longer than two minutes each.
- They should feature only you speaking—no screenshots or post-production work is needed. The focus is on the strength of your words and ideas, not your video production skills.

Video and Audio Tips:

- Film your videos in a well-lit location, with the primary light source in front of you to illuminate your face rather than behind you, which will cause silhouetting.
- Film your videos in a quiet space without background noise that might make your voice less audible. Avoid filming in loud, crowded, or windy places where your voice will echo and/or your microphone may be distorted.
- Speak loudly and clearly, and review your videos several times before submitting, making sure your voice is clear and can easily be heard.
- You may upload your videos in the following formats: mkv, mov, mp4, and MPEG.
- Files should be no larger than 400 MB each.
- The selection committee does not assess the production quality of personal video statements. Videos may be recorded on your phone or computer or with an external camera. The most important part of your videos is the opportunity to get to know you.

If you have connectivity that doesn't allow you to upload a video, please reach out to Submittable Technical Support, or by clicking on the "?" icon in the upper right corner of your screen, or email globalleaders@obama.org for alternative submission options.

Prompt 1: Throughout his career, President Obama has embraced a leadership approach grounded in core principles and beliefs that influence both individual actions and collective outcomes. In the Obama Leaders program, we call this values-based leadership, and it forms the foundation of our curriculum. Please tell us about a specific, deeply held value that defines your changemaking. Share a personal story that illustrates how you put this value into practice under pressure, and highlight how this value guides the

community, country, or region that is the focus of your work. (requis)

Choisir le fichier

Télécharger un fichier. Aucun fichier en pièce jointe.

Types de fichiers acceptables: .mkv, .mov, .mp4, .mpg

If you have connectivity that doesn't allow you to upload a video, please reach out to Submittable Technical Support, or by clicking on the "?" icon in the upper right corner of your screen, or email globalleaders@obama.org for alternative submission options.

Prompt 2: True progress requires working with those who do not always share your background, ideology, or goals. Describe a challenging situation in your changemaking work where you had to navigate differing opinions or deep-seated disagreement to work toward a shared goal. What did this experience teach you about your own leadership style? (requis)

Choisir le fichier

Télécharger un fichier. Aucun fichier en pièce jointe.

Types de fichiers acceptables: .mkv, .mov, .mp4, .mpg

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SHORT BIOGRAPHY

Please write a short biography in the third person using the sample provided below as a guide.

B I U

h

1 / 125 mots

Short Biography Tips

- Your biography should offer a concise narrative of your background and highlight a few key experiences or professional positions that best illustrate your pathway into changemaking. Please do not include awards, honors, publications, or university or graduate degrees.
- Feel free to also reference the bios of real Leaders on our website to get a sense of how your bio might be used if you are selected.
- Please be aware that if you are selected for the program, a portion or the entirety of this biography may be published. The Obama Foundation retains the rights to make edits while preserving the original meaning.
- Your answer must be between 75 and 125 words. The application form will not accept responses that fall outside of the specified word range.

Example: Laila Keller is a Global Programs Associate for the Leaders Africa program at The Obama Foundation, an organization that strives to inspire, empower, and connect people to change their world. She has worked on girls' education initiatives in Tanzania, Ghana, and Ethiopia and draws inspiration from the dedication of schoolteachers who strive to uplift their students daily, guiding them toward realizing their full potential. Driven by a strong commitment to leadership development, Laila supports a growing network of innovative changemakers across the continent of Africa.

RÉSUMÉ

Your résumé responses should highlight the experiences that you believe are most **relevant** to your leadership journey. An exhaustive timeline of your professional background is not required. If your experience, such as freelance or creative work, does not match the prompts exactly, feel free to adapt your answers in the way that best reflects your background.

Please be aware that if selected, a portion or the entirety of this résumé may be published by The Obama Foundation. The Obama Foundation retains the rights to make edits while preserving the original meaning.

Section A: Relevant Professional Experience

Please list up to 5 positions.

Position 1: Organization/Company Name: (requis)

Position 1: Your Role/Title: (requis)

Position 1: Start Date (MM/DD/YYYY) (requis)

Position 1: Is this a present position?

- Yes
- No

Position 1: Key Responsibilities & Key Achievements: (requis)

Limite: 100 mots

Would you like to add another position? (requis)

- Yes
- No

Section B: Volunteerism & Community Engagement

Please share up to five relevant non-paid roles, community organizing, advisory work, or volunteer commitments relevant to your application.

Activity 1: Organization Name:

Activity 1: Role / Title (e.g., Volunteer, Board Member, Community Organizer):

Activity 1: Involvement Start Date (MM/DD/YYYY)

Activity 1: Is this a current activity?

- Yes
- No

Activity 1: Summary of Contributions & Impact:

Limite: 100 mots

Would you like to add another activity?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Section C: Education & Formal Training

Please share up to five relevant qualifications. Include formal degrees, certifications, or trade training relevant to your journey.

Qualification 1: Institution Name:

Qualification 1: Degree / Certification Earned:

Qualification 1: Field of Study:

Qualification 1: Graduation / Completion Year (YYYY):

Limite: 4 personnages

Would you like to add another qualification?

- ◯

Section E: Honors, Awards & Fellowships

Have you been recognized for your changemaking work by honors or awards, including prizes or sponsorships? (requis)

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

This question is meant to help us learn more about your background. We welcome applicants regardless of recognition.

Have you participated in other merit-based or competitive application leadership development programs or fellowships? (requis)

- ◯ Yes

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Have you participated in other merit-based or competitive application leadership development programs or fellowships? (requis)

- ◯ Yes

- ◯ No

This question is meant to help us learn more about your background. We welcome applicants regardless of program and fellowship experience.

If you use social media as part of your changemaking work, please select all of the accounts you use.

- ☐ Bluesky
- ☐ LinkedIn
- ☐ X (formerly known as Twitter)
- ☐ Facebook/Meta
- ☐ Instagram
- ☐ TikTok
- ☐ Other

OPTIONAL SECTION: ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

The Obama Foundation holds the conviction that assembling leaders with a range of experiences, approaches, backgrounds, and divergent points of view will enhance inclusion and belonging and enrich the learning experience for everyone. To better understand our applicant pool, we offer those applying for the Leaders program the opportunity to share information about all this with us. Responding to any of these questions is strictly voluntary. If you do not wish to complete any part of this section, please proceed to the rest of the application. If you wish to provide additional information, we ask that you agree to The Obama Foundation's Privacy Statement.

By checking this box, you agree that the Foundation may review and use the optional additional information that you provide in order to better understand you as a person and applicant. Some of the data requested in this part may be considered "special category" data (for example, data relating to union membership, religious beliefs, race or ethnic origin) under certain data protection regulations, which is why we request your separate consent to allow us to process such information. By selecting "yes" below, you are providing your explicit consent to the processing of any special category personal data that you provide in this section by The Obama Foundation as described herein and in our Privacy Statement (linked below). Consenting to share some or all of this information is purely optional. You may withdraw your consent at any time by emailing the Foundation at privacy@obama.org. (requis)

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Privacy Statement

Please be aware that if you choose not to check the box above, this optional section of the application will be skipped, and you will proceed directly to the next section.

DATA PRIVACY AND TERMS & CONDITIONS

Data Privacy The data you have supplied in this application will be processed as a part of the selection process for The Obama Foundation Leaders program.

For more information about how we process personal data, including how to exercise your rights to your personal data and information about how we transfer this information to and process it in the United States, please review our Privacy Statement.

Notice of GDPR This section is for you if you are located in the European Economic Area ("EEA") and other countries like the UK or Switzerland, where the law includes certain rights and protections under the law regarding the processing of your personal data.

Legal Basis for Processing In addition to what is described in the Foundation's Privacy Statement, we may process your personal data in the following situations:

We need to use your personal data to perform our responsibilities under our contract with you. For example, we may process your personal data to facilitate any merchandise purchases you might make.

We have a legitimate interest in processing your personal data. For example, we may process your personal data to evaluate and improve our programs and offerings.

We have your consent to do so. For example, we will seek your consent before processing your personal data in connection with an event we are hosting.

We have a legal obligation to process your personal data. For example, we may need to retain information about your donations or purchases to comply with our legal obligations.

Data Subject Requests Subject to certain limitations, you have the right to access personal data we hold about you and to ask that your personal data be corrected, erased, or transferred. You may also have the right to object to, or request that we restrict, certain processing. If you would like to exercise any of these rights, you may contact us as indicated below.

Questions or Complaints Contact us at globalleaders@obama.org with data subject requests. If you have a concern about our processing of personal data that we are not able to resolve, you have the right to lodge a complaint with the data privacy authority where you reside.

- For contact details of your local Data Protection Authority, visit: http://ec.europa.eu/justice/data-protection/article-29/structure/data-protection authorities/index_en.htm
- For individuals in the EEA, visit: https://edpb.europa.eu/about-edpb/board/members_en
- For individuals in the UK, visit: https://ico.org.uk/global/contact-us/
- For individuals in Switzerland, visit: https://www.edoeb.admin.ch/edoeb/en/home/the-fdpic/contact.html

Consent and Agreement

☐ I have read and agree to the Foundation's Terms of Service, including the Submission Terms. I further consent to the processing of my personal data by the Foundation as described herein and in The Obama Foundation's Privacy Statement and agree to the transfer of my personal data to and subsequent processing within the United States. I declare that the information I have shared in this application is true, complete, and accurate.
(requis)

Terms of Service; Submission Terms; Privacy Statement

Opt-in to Other Communications

☐ By checking this box (optional), you are requesting to receive communications from the Leaders Program, as well as the latest Foundation news and updates, at the email address you provided with your application. To learn more about how the Foundation would use your email, read our Privacy Statement.

Privacy Statement

⚠ You are about to submit your application. ⚠

Correcting mistakes or making edits after your application has been submitted, including reference requests, is not allowed.

To complete and submit your application use the 'Continue' button below. Your email service provider will sometimes try to predict incoming spam mail on your behalf and filter it into your spam folder before you ever see it. If you're not receiving expected emails from notifications@email.submittable.com, you will want to safelist the address to help ensure that these emails reach you. How can I safelist notifications from Submittable?

If you use the 'Continue' button and are not taken to the submission confirmation screen and are not taken to a specific incomplete field, please re-review the application to ensure you completed all required fields. For any technical questions about the platform, please visit this website.

Enregistrer le brouillon | Continuer

Dernière sauvegarde il y a 2 minutes

Les brouillons peuvent être visibles par les administrateurs de ce programme.